

Frozen features

The Arctic and Antarctica are among the most remote, or hard to get to, places on Earth. The Arctic is a freezing-cold region that is mostly water. Antarctica is a continent almost totally covered by ice. Very low temperatures affect these places and transform their landscapes.

! WOW!

Antarctica is the **coldest, driest, and windiest** continent. It is **technically a desert!**

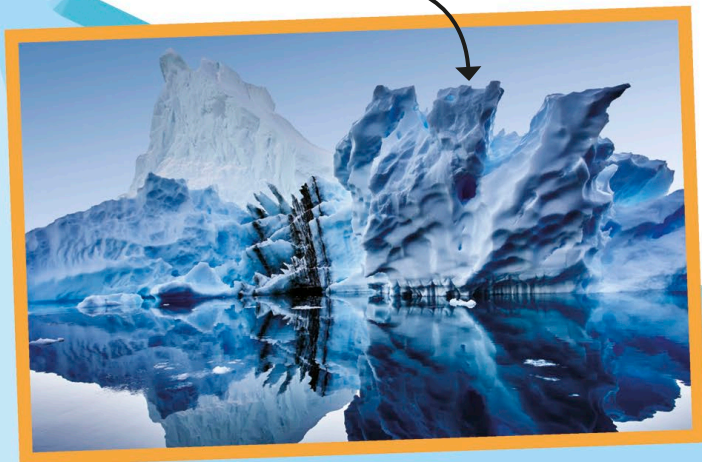
Ice shelves

Most ice shelves are found in Antarctica. These giant platforms form where a glacier or ice sheet moves slowly down to the coastline. Antarctica's record-breaking Ross Ice Shelf is about the same size as France!

Ice shelves attached to the Antarctic coastline



An iceberg floating along a strip of water in Greenland



Icebergs

When great chunks of ice break off from a glacier or ice sheet, they float out to sea as icebergs. Less than 20 percent of the total iceberg is visible above the surface of the water.